PETROLEUM

Robert Chesebrough



Robert Augustus Chesebrough, (January 9, 1837 – September 8, 1933) was an American chemist.

He discovered petroleum jelly which he marketed as Vaseline and he founded the Chesebrough Manufacturing Company.

Chesebrough began his career as a chemist clarifying kerosene from the oil of sperm whales.

The discovery of petroleum in Titusville, Pennsylvania, rendered his job obsolete, so he traveled to Titusville to research what new materials might be created from the new fuel.

This led to his discovery of petroleum jelly, which he trade-named as Vaseline.

In 1875, he founded the Chesebrough Manufacturing Company that in 1955 became Chesebrough-Ponds, a leading manufacturer of personal-care products. Chesebrough patented the process of making petroleum jelly (U.S. Patent 127,568) in 1872.



3.1.2.1 Petrol and Its Properties

Most liquid fuels are derived from the fossilized remains of dead plants and animals by exposure to heat and pressure in the Earth's crust.From the crude oil, by distillation process, various components like Liquid Petroleum Gas (at 40°C), petrol (40°C to 200°C), Diesel (250°C to 300°C) and residue tar (above 350°C) are extracted. Figure 3.1.2.1 shows the distilation process of various components useages.

Petrol, also known as Gasoline, is a transparent fuel derived from crude oil and is used as fuel in internal combustion engines. Petrol is separated from crude oil from 40°C to 200°C. Petrol is usually a blend of paraffin's, naphthenic, aromatics and olefins. Figure 3.1.2.1(a) shown the Line Diagram of Distilation Process of Various Components.

Table: Chemical composition of petrol by weight

Element	Percentage by weight
Carbon	79.5 – 87.1
Hydrogen	11.5 – 14.8
Sulphur	0.1 – 3.5
Oxygen	0.1 – 0.3
Nitrogen	0.1 – 2.0

The following are the properties of petrol:

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